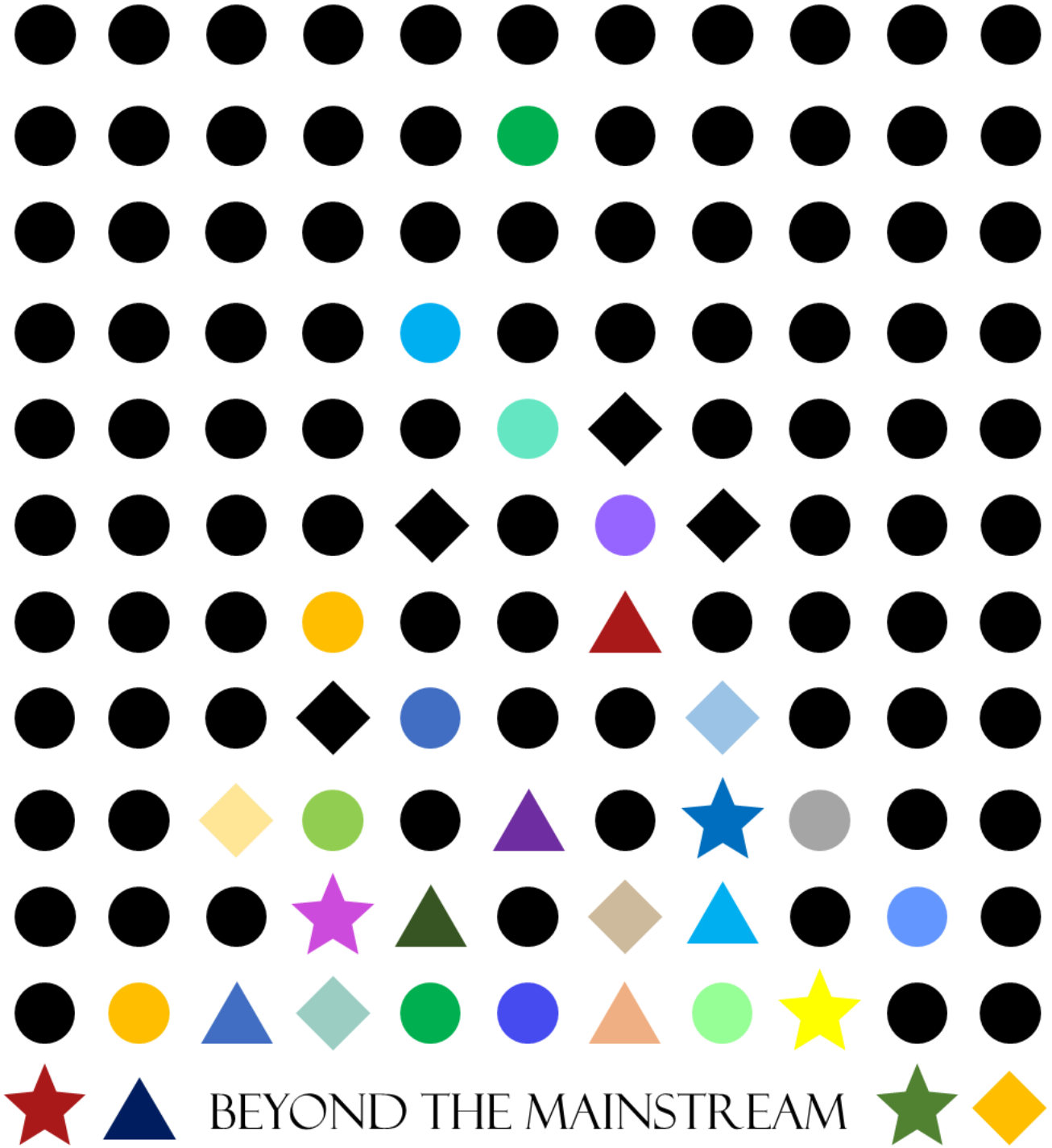
MINJOK HERALD

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Editor’s Note

What is it that propels us to do irrational things? Even when others try to keep us away, there are moments when we are compelled to pour out our hearts fully and entirely. Time, money, relationships, they all fade away — and what is left is passion. Why look over articles, why finish that novel just days before the exam? It is only explainable that writing is my passion. Passion allows us to pull through hardships, and it is what has led me through the turbulence that was the second semester of 2024.

The 71st Edition delivers on the theme of "**Beyond the Mainstream.**" In a world that praises rationality as its primary virtue, the mainstream is dominated by calculations and probabilities that predict the statistical trend of individuals. If you are intelligent and capable, following a certain career path will "make the most sense." We have turned our focus to the mainstream, so much so, that we rarely think beyond it. In truth, there exist individuals who strive with passion and others who struggle under neglect. Beyond the mainstream, there are distinct individuals who push the limits of human potential; there are innovative theories that present unprecedented perspectives; there is passion.

Yet passion cannot walk alone; with others alongside to help, the journey is much more manageable and more importantly, enjoyable. The Minjok Herald crew, along with the best supervising teacher, have produced a wonderful effort that has raised standards once again. The critical and creative minds continue to search for expression within their articles, bringing to surface the underlying problems of our school. Their ideas and writing style have often surprised me, and I can only look forward to what the future will bring. With best wishes to the next Editor-in-Chief Hyunseo Lee, who will no doubt lead the club to further excellence, I can now store away my story with Minjok Herald knowing its future lies in great hands.

Best wishes for the future,
27th Editor-in-Chief,
Sangmin Lee



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NEWS

Minsaeum

The First Half

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Parents' Quoir / Minjok Orchestra / KMLA Orchestra

The Second Half

Samuchim / Rhyme Factory / SYNERGY / 갈아만든 배 / PLZ
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KMLA Homecoming Day:
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Hee-won Hong / Park Yeo-jun / Geon-hyeon / Lee Joo-eun

MBTI Special

ENTP_Taegang Yim
ISFJ_Seoyoung Won
INFJ_Jaeyoon Kim & Yunjin Lee
ESTJ_Jaehu Cho

Minsaeum 2024

A Grand Tapestry of KMLA Brilliance

The First Half

"Myeong geum ilha~ Dae~ chwi~ ta~!"

Silence sets in. Then, the Korean trumpets and horns kick in. The rhythm picks up, and before you know it, you're in the middle of a traditional Korean royal march, also the start of a grand KMLA concert festival — the long-awaited Minsaeum. Daechwita, boasting a 27-year tradition, always starts off the event. The 29th wavers, each with a traditional instrument, play "Arirang," "Muryeongjigok," and "Pungnyeonga."

After a short pause, the stage is graced by the presence of the Gayageums, beautiful string instruments that light up the stage with the pleasant, dulcet melody of "Canon." A moment later the Daegeums join in, and together they play the melancholic instrumental of "걱정말아요 그대."

Next is the Parents' Choir, an organization rich with tradition, consisting of parents of both alumni and students. They sing "나 하나 꽃피어" and "Libertango," hopeful melodies that heal our souls. They lead beautifully into the next performance — the orchestras.

KMLA Orchestra, displaying their talent for classical music, go from the ethereal "Dance of the Sugar Plum Fairy" to the enchanting world of "Howl's Moving Castle", leaving off with a grand "From the New World" (4th Movement). Next follows Minjok Orchestra, a fusion of Korean Traditional and classical instruments. They go from "Happiness" to "A Town with an Ocean View", painting the peaceful coastal village with their variety of instruments, and ending their performance — as well as the first half of the event — with an upbeat, powerful "Frontier."











The Second Half

If you weren't prepared for the second half, Samuchim will hit you with a surprise. The overwhelming grandeur of the Samulnori performance leaves the audience stunned — even after the performance is over, it takes a moment for them to react, and then a wave of applause crashes in. Don't rest easy though, the second half is full of exciting performances; if you were savoring the beautiful melodies in the first half, now you're standing, shouting, and clapping.

Rhyme Factory needs no introduction; neither does their dominance on stage. Feel as the speakers blast pure hip-hop, and the rappers and dancers take over the entire grand hall. Ride yourself through the relentless lyrics and the stunning combination of dance moves as the 29th Wavers perform "08Basick" and "VENI VIDI VICI."

Next is the Band Union. Three bands performed this year: SYNERGY, 갈아 만든 배, and PLZ, all with their distinct flavors. SYNERGY kicks off with Bruno Mars's "Runaway Baby," where the two vocals form an energetic harmony. 갈아 만든 배, a one-time band organized just for the Minsaeum, performs "하여가" by 서태지와 아이들 — and a crazy sequence of guitar solo is there to shock you. The rock band PLZ is already famous for their skill; still, they surprise the audience yet again with their take on "미인" by 신중현과 엽전들.

It's not just the students or their parents performing in this school festival, no; the teachers are back this year with the oldie but goodie, 귀뚜라미 by An Chihwan. It's 바위와 조약돌, a trio of Ms. Chung Yoonyoung, Mr. Kim Yonsoo, and Mr. Song Wonho. Needless to say, every student is singing along — as well as many parents on the first floor. The trio's enthusiastic singing is met with a loud, resounding shout of "Encore!" from the audience, and the classic "바위처럼" plays. And of course, the students sing along.

It's not over just yet; get ready to witness The Scene. They reenact "Frozen," and just for a moment, we're back in 2013, singing along to the fresh, upbeat melodies. Singing, dancing, acting — all of it is there, and the coordination is amazingly done. "The 29th wave vocals are so good at singing!" a 28th Waver comments.

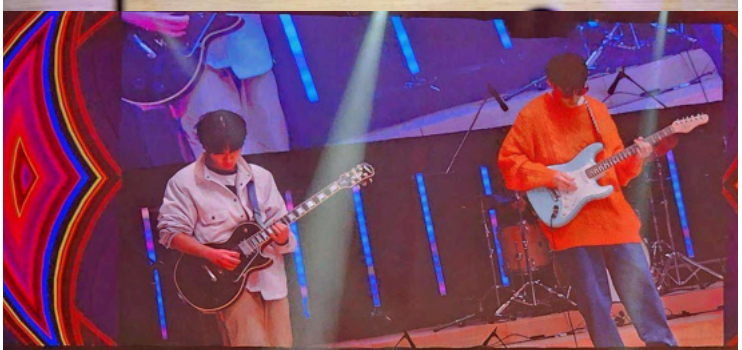
And the last performance is the most touching of all; it is, of course, the Student Choir. The freshmen have almost made it to the end of the year, and the Minsaeum is also coming to an end. The last touch of this grand symphony is the songs "노래를 부르지," "깊은 밤을 날아서," and "붉은 노을." The students sing one very last song — the school song — and as the last melodies fade, the lights turn back on and we are back in the Hoengseong Performance Art Theatre. Minsaeum has ended.













The Afterglow

Did you enjoy the ride? Words can only describe a fraction of the thrill, the resonance, the sensation of the real event. It's not just sounds; it is the culmination of all of the student's efforts, their talents, their brilliance. On the big stage, students perform knowing that every one of their peers, parents, and teachers are watching. What an event.

Let the value of this experience be defined by our progress and growth, not just by the final result — although, anyone present on the day will tell you the results were phenomenal as well. From the start of the year, we've practiced relentlessly, during dinner time, self-study time, and on weekends. Several times we've had rehearsals, including the two that we did the day before the event and on the morning of the event. It is our collective effort that constitutes this impossibly monumental achievement that is the Minsaeum.

Headmaster Park Hashik, returning to the school this year, comments on the event: "There were Minsaeums in the past, but this is my first time seeing one of this scale. Each performance was beautiful and touching, and I'm proud of the 29th, 28th Wavers. To think that they practiced through the busy schedule of our school.. I felt all of their efforts were precious." When asked about the most memorable moment, he answered: "Every one of them was great, but considering our school slogan of ‘Korea in heart, World in mind,’ I think Minjok Orchestra fit that message the most." His final thoughts on the event? "I wish the Minsaeum allows the KMLA Family to be proud of our school, as it's an invaluable tradition."

A parent also commented, "It was amazing.. It was hard to believe that everything I saw today was performed by students. KMLA students are blessed to have peers that are so talented." She added, "Every time my son was on the screen, I was delighted — and I'm sure every parent today was proud to see theirs."

It's November, less than two months away from a new year. We've all made it — and our efforts practicing and perfecting for the Minsaeum have paid off magnificently. Certainly, it's a once-in-a-lifetime event that will be remembered in the years to come, although blessed as we KMLA students are, we get to witness it twice. What was your sound at the event, and what does the Minsaeum mean to you?

MINJOK HERALD

Humans of Minsa:
Minsaeum Special



Daechwita

29th waver Doohyun Kwon

For our Daechwita performance, we performed the songs "Arirang," "Muryeongjigok," and "Pungnyeonga." These pieces are based on royal court music, so they're less upbeat and require more precision, which I think makes them special. There were some unfamiliar instruments, like Nabal and Jabara, which were challenging at first but we learned quickly thanks to our instructor.

As for the performance, it was our first opening act. We only found out on the day of the event that we would be walking in and performing, which made everyone nervous. But after it was over, the applause from the parents was incredibly encouraging. Despite the nerves at the start, the performance turned out to be our best. Hearing the applause and feeling the sense of accomplishment afterward was an amazing experience.

KMLA Orchestra

28th waver Sooyun Bae

We performed Tchaikovsky's "Dance of the Sugar Plum Fairy," Joe Hisaishi's "Merry-Go-Round of Life," and Dvořák's Symphony No. 9 in E Minor, "From the New World" (4th Movement).

At times it was difficult to manage all of the members as a conductor, but it was that much more rewarding when they followed along well and supported me. To have something that kept me busy for a year finally be over, it's refreshing – but it does leave a bittersweet feeling to think that this is the end.

Lastly, and most of all, I'm grateful to all the members for doing so well.



Samuchim

29th waver Jeyoon Lee

We practiced almost every day for about seven months, starting in early May, and at first, it was tough — especially with the unfamiliar instruments — but we improved significantly over time with the help of 28th wavers. During the two-day rehearsal and concert, I realized just how different the actual performance was from practice. I start the performance with a loud shout, and during practice I received criticism for my soft voice; on stage, I was able to shout much better.

For our performance, we did a 3-note Samulnori, which is a bit different from the usual style; it's more powerful and dynamic. The audience's great response made the performance even more rewarding. I'm really proud of how far we've come, especially since some members who struggled at first performed flawlessly today. As the Buk drum captain, I'm really proud of them and want to give them lots of praise. I also want to thank all members, and I hope we can continue to work hard together next year.





Band Union: SYNERGY

28th waver Seongbin Park

I played the guitar in the band Synergy, and we performed Bruno Mars's song "Runaway Baby."

Difficulties? We practiced our song for a long time, since last year, so at times it did feel a bit repetitive.. But after today's performance, I feel so refreshed — we did so well. I'm proud of us. I want to thank our vocals for engaging the audience so well and leading the performance, as well as the rest of the band for everything.

Well done, Synergy!

KMLA Homecoming Day:

A Heartwarming Reunion of Memories and Connections

Suh-yoon Jahng

Visiting one's alma mater often brings a wave of nostalgia for school days. For KMLAians, who forge strong friendships over their three years together, such visits can feel particularly poignant. On November 30th, KMLA hosted its annual Homecoming Day. Alumni spanning generations, from the 2nd to the 26th wave, gathered early in the morning to reconnect with their school and each other.

The event began at noon with an opening ceremony held in the Dasan Auditorium. Mrs. Hwang So-hee, a 10th-wave graduate and current KMLA teacher, delivered a warm welcoming speech. She encouraged attendees to reminisce about their school years while fostering meaningful connections through networking.

Following the ceremony, alumni moved to the cafeteria on the 12th floor of the dormitory, where they enjoyed a nostalgic meal of school lunch and honjung bread. For many, this simple treat brought back memories of student life, with some tasting it again after 20 years.

At 1:30 p.m., a guided campus tour began, pairing alumni and their families with current students as tour guides. The groups, divided into 18 teams, explored the snowy campus, visiting both familiar and newly constructed buildings. Photo zones were set up in front of the gym, the Minjok building, and Dasan Hall, where alumni could even try on school uniforms for pictures.

Jiwoong Choi, a 5th-wave alumnus, shared his thoughts saying, "So much has changed since I graduated! It felt like I was stepping back into my school days. I had a wonderful time with my son and daughter, though I think my son enjoyed rolling in the snow the most. (laughs)"







After the tour, attendees split into three activities: a mentoring program with students, a magic show performed by the Illusion magic club, and a networking program exclusively for alumni. The mentoring session was a highlight for many students. Based on a pre-survey of personal interests and career aspirations, groups of 7-8 students were matched with an alumnus. This provided an invaluable opportunity for students to ask questions about life after high school and to hear stories of cherished KMLA memories.

Meanwhile, the networking program allowed alumni to reconnect with peers they hadn't seen in years. Grouped by shared interests—such as legal profession, broadcasting, or work-life balance with parenting—they spent an hour discussing common challenges, exchanging advice, and offering support and encouragement.

The day concluded with a lively closing ceremony featuring a lucky draw. Alumni eagerly watched as numbers flashed on the screen, hoping theirs would be called. Winners leaped out of their seats to claim their prizes, introducing themselves briefly on stage. Notable winners included a 2nd wave alumnus who attended with his son, aspiring to join KMLA, and an alumni couple accompanied by their one-year-old child.

As the sun set, attendees began to say their goodbyes. Some hurried to catch buses, while others chose to stay overnight at Gajung-gwan, extending their time on campus. Farewells were filled with lingering emotion as the day came to a close.

Homecoming Day offered a cherished opportunity for alumni to relive old memories, reconnect with friends, and rekindle their bond with KMLA. It was a powerful reminder of the enduring value of these connections. May the ties among KMLAians continue to thrive and inspire for generations to come.



Humans of Minsa:
Homecoming Special



5th waver
Jooyoung Jung

Coming back to KMLA, it feels very warm and it reminds me of the old memories. After becoming an adult, I learned that being humble is important. I hope you all know this and practice this!

5th waver
Hyobeom Park

It feels refreshing coming back to KMLA and there are memories in every corner of this place. I want you to know that grades are not everything and don't be too focused on it. Also, you have to spend a lot of time thinking about what you want to pursue and not compare your vision to others'. Have your own standard and build your own future with it.



5th waver Jaehyung Cha

Visiting KMLA made me realize how beautiful this school was. Coming back after a long time makes it look even more beautiful. To KMLAians still in this school, I hope you know that there is a much bigger world outside. Don't settle for less and never lose your spark.

8th waver Soojin Lim

I was an international track student many years ago here in KMLA. It is surprising how this school is the same as it was 20 years ago. It feels so warm to see the KMLA family connect in such a nice event! For the ones still in KMLA, I hope you chose what you want over something stable.



9th waver Daehan Lee

This visit is special for me because my children are accompanying me to a place where I spent my adolescence. It snowed a lot when we came here today, which reminded me of planting trees under the snow, twenty years ago on Arbor day. I don't think those trees are here anymore, but seeing the snow today on campus conjured up a poignant memory.

Another vivid memory is of a song I listened to with my then-roommate, called 'Snowmelt(눈녹듯)' from Panic 04. We listened to it through winter. He said he played it again on the way here today and maybe I should too, on the way home, though my children will probably say, "Daddy, let's play something else!"



Best of Humans of Minsa

29th waver Yeo-Jun Park

I definitely caught a lot of attention. It was only thanks to my costume that covered my face, that I felt a bit more confident walking around.

The most memorable (frightening) reaction came from my teacher, Mr. Kim Tae-wan. He was holding a bamboo sword (Jukdo) during class, and he jokingly warned me to be careful not to surprise him because he might accidentally hit me with it while teaching!



On Halloween Day...



29th waver Hee-won Hong

First off, why did you originally decide to grow your hair? How did you feel about all the attention you received?

Honestly, the original reason was that I didn't like going to the hair salon to get my hair cut. So I told my mom I wanted to grow it out—mainly as a way to avoid going to the salon while pretending it was just a "style choice." Since middle school, I'd always gotten attention because of my hair, so I expected similar reactions here. But it was definitely new when the principal took such a strong interest, even mentioning me during school information sessions. I had initially planned to cut it when I started high school, but my middle school teachers told me they wanted to see me come to the Alma Mater Homecoming Day in a hanbok (traditional Korean attire) with a long braid. So, I decided to keep it long until then.
I finally got around to cutting my hair over the break. Since I had already decided to donate my hair, I was pretty calm about cutting it. I definitely like it better now with my haircut. And one more thing—it's a bit funny, but a lot of people, including the principal, believe that I grew my hair out to donate it from the beginning. At this point, it feels a bit too late to correct that misunderstanding, so whenever there are adults around, I just go along with it and say I grew it out to donate.

28th waver Geon-hyeon Kim



I am Kim Geon-hyeon, a 28th-waver, the president of the 37th Executive Council. I'm interested in social sciences and have an active personality, often taking on leadership roles. Previously I served as a Legislative Council member, but I realized that my outgoing nature and desire to lead students made the Executive Council a better fit for me.

As a president, I've faced challenges like balancing work and personal life. I cope with stress by talking to friends and indulging in my interests, such as watching political science lectures or reading related papers. These activities help me relieve stress by focusing on what I truly enjoy, aside from obligatory schoolwork.

My motto, which guides me through high school, is to understand myself better. Serving as the president of the Executive Council has been a valuable experience, showing me that I'm more capable of handling public roles than I initially thought. I've also learned that small administrative tasks might not align with my strengths. Engaging in diverse activities and challenging courses has helped me discover more about myself, and this self-awareness is central to my high school journey.



29th waver Joo-eun Lee

Hi, I am Lee Joo-Eun, a 29th waver.

I have my philosophy of life. I want to live a life without comparison, regret, or shame. And to live a life without comparison, I should better focus on myself. I would like to be a person who understands herself well such as getting rest at the right time and doing things that I am good at. Next, I will live an unregretful life by trying to reckon that the past is in the past. As the past is unchangeable, I will try my best in the present. Lastly, one of my favorite poems, Prelude by Yun Dong-Ju, has a line that says, "Looking up to the sky, I hope there is no stain of shame in my life." As my dream career is related to society and politics, I hope I don't work for people who can give me unfair monetary benefits.

Lastly, I would like to thank my matching seniors. Living a 16-year-long life, they were the ones who I had the most to learn. From the first night of matching seniors, they have tried their best to be friendly to us. They are all so good at their field of interest and also have warm personalities. I feel sorry for them for not expressing my gratitude and respect towards them. They are the biggest reason I don't regret coming to this school. I feel thankful for the whole 6 months we've spent until now, and thank you forever.

Humans of Minsa: MBTI Special

Daeun Song

In recent years, MBTI has become a popular concept that is frequently used to understand others. It's often seen as the easiest way to explain and justify someone's behavior. But how meaningful is MBTI, really? While it might hold value in contexts where people lead diverse lifestyles, its relevance in a setting like KMLA—where students share a largely uniform lifestyle—raises questions. Can MBTI truly serve as a mainstream method for uncovering personality, or does it belong beyond the mainstream, offering insights that challenge conventional norms? Minjok Herald conducted interviews with students to find out how different MBTIs each led their KMLA lives.

ENTP : 29th waver Taegang Yim

What is your own definition of success in KMLA?

Simply getting into a good university—ultimately, having a specific plan for the future and learning a lot along the way.

When do you feel stressed and happy at KMLA?

I'm especially happy during club activities. While it fills the EC requirement, it's fun because it aligns with my interests. What's tough is studying to maintain my GPA.

If you could have anything you want at KMLA, what would it be?

I'd want intelligence. I believe intelligence can fulfill practically everything. As for friendships, I think I'm doing well enough already, so I don't really have any particular wishes there.

If you were unfairly given a penalty point and were too busy with assignments, would you write a final statement of appeal or just accept it?

In reality, I don't get many penalty points, so I wouldn't be too concerned. But actually, in the past, there was a time when I felt it was unfair, but I didn't write an appeal because it was too much trouble.

ISFJ : 29th waver Seoyoung Won

What is your own definition of success in KMLA?

I think it starts with something small. Success comes from accumulated efforts and achieving small goals one by one, leading to larger goals. For example, by reaching planned small milestones one by one, you eventually achieve your life goals.

When do you feel stressed and happy at KMLA?

I feel happy when I write down even minor schedules in my study planner and complete everything as expected without any regrets.
On the other hand, I feel stressed when I fail to achieve what I aim for or when the quality of my work doesn't meet my expectations due to my laziness. It leads to self-doubt and a bad mood.

What if you could have anything you want at KMLA?

I want self-discipline. Before I was exposed to electronic devices as a child, I used to perfectly keep the promises I made to myself. That was my source of confidence and ability. However, after encountering various devices, I feel like obstacles keep interfering with my plans. I'd like the self-discipline to put down my phone when necessary.

What if your roommate suddenly lost their memory, and you had to help them? What would you feel and do?

I think I'd feel scared. We would've built memories and shared many moments, so even entering the room to feel comfortable might feel strange. I'd probably try to help them recover their memory step by step, using examples and reminders.

INFJ : 28th waver Jaeyoon Kim & 28th waver Yunjin Lee

What is your own definition of success in KMLA?

Kim: That's such a profound question!

Lee: Sorry, INFJ traits! I'd think about a question like this for an hour.

Kim: Isn't it just being happy right now? That's what I think.

Lee: I also think that being happy means success. But at KMLA, I believe success is about creating your own unique story, something different from others.

When do you feel stressed and happy at KMLA?

Kim: I'm happiest when I eat school meals.

Lee: I was about to say the same thing!

Kim: Right? Eating school meals is the best—actually, the only happiness.

Lee: I feel stressed when I don't get good grades.

Kim: I feel stressed when I lose faith in humanity. I'm serious—like when sincerity gets undermined, I get really upset.

What if your roommate suddenly lost their memory, and you had to help them? What would you feel and do?

Kim: Wouldn't it be incredibly despairing? Like, "Who are you?"

Lee: I think it would be interesting and fun. Since the person doesn't remember anything, they wouldn't feel pain from the loss. They're like a blank slate! If I were in a position to help, I'd tell them how they got here and who they are. And because they're a blank slate, I'd try to shape them into a really good person.

Kim: Oh, me too. It's not that my current roommate is bad or anything, but being a blank slate gives them the best conditions to become a good person.

Lee: Right. It's like raising a baby.

What if your favorite friend asked you to go to a public observatory event with them, but you haven't finished your tasks, what would you do?

Lee: I don't think I'd go. I don't like going to the observatory event enough to prioritize it over my responsibilities. But if someone brought really delicious food, I might waver. I could give up and go.

Kim: I think I'd go if it's for a friend I like. I feel like I'd go no matter where it is. I know I won't finish everything I plan to do anyway.

Lee: That's true for me too. It's just that the observatory event doesn't interest me that much.

ESTJ : 28th waver Jaehu Cho

When do you feel happy or stressed at KMLA?

I'm happy when I'm chatting with close friends—whether it's with several people or one-on-one. I especially enjoy talking while walking between classes.
As for stress, I remember feeling stressed during my first year when I had to do the KMS stretches on the cold floor during kendo training.

Do you plan things ahead? If so, how do you plan things?

I always make plans. For weekdays, I divide my schedule into blocks like 1st or 2nd free periods. Before going to bed, I jot down what I'll do the next day in a memo. Then, the next morning, I organize it further on Over the Time.

What if there's a sports game you've been eagerly waiting for from 10 PM to midnight, but you haven't finished the work you must complete today? What would you do?

I'd adjust flexibly. If it's soccer, for example, I'd watch the first half and study in between halftime. Then I'd watch the game from 11 PM to midnight. I'd make up for the remaining work by cutting back on sleep. I tend to adapt to situations like this.

If you strongly believed you were right about something but later found out you were wrong, what would you do?

Once I realize I'm wrong, I'd just say, "Oh, you were right earlier," and leave it at that. However, if the argument involved me saying something hurtful, I'd apologize. In a simple debate, I'd cleanly admit I was wrong and move on. But if I made a mistake during the process, I'd make sure to apologize for it.



EDITORIAL

"Journalists should be watchdogs, not lapdogs," Newton Lee said. Every community faces its own chronic challenges. And the true competence of a community can be assessed when we observe how it confronts and resolves these problems. In this process, the role of journalism as a watchdog is pivotal. It is the duty of journalists, being the watchdogs, to provide continuous oversight and constructive criticism. Since its founding, KMLA has also had to go through several challenges, and we have dealt with them in our own ways. The Editorial Department seeks to promote constructive debate in the school about various issues: Eton and KMLA, the new EOP policy changes, issues regarding the science lab, department inequality, AI ethics, and the Press during student council elections.

Beyond the Bubble of Eton: It's Time to be KMLA

Jeonggyum Kuk

"Schools of tradition nurturing leaders through quality education."
"Institutions cultivating leaders who practice noblesse oblige."
"Elite schools accessible only to the wealthy."
"Schools living in a world of their own, detached from reality."

These descriptions of Eton College and other public schools* in the UK, paradoxically, all carry a degree of fact, though opinions differ on which is closer to the truth. Interestingly, similar evaluations are often made about KMLA, founded by Choi Myung-jae after being inspired by Eton College.

Similarities between Public Schools and KMLA

Education of National Culture

Both Eton and KMLA emphasize national culture in their missions. Eton College is still teaching their students in the old buildings where they used to, and they still have their students wear formal suit uniforms. KMLA similarly emphasizes national culture. The school further emphasizes this value by making its building Hanok and requiring its students to wear Hanbok.

Gifted Education

Both institutions place a significant emphasis on gifted education. Rigorous admissions processes, the recruitment of outstanding teachers, investment in facilities, and excellent college placement results are all strengths they also have in common. Eton provides the best academic environment, and thanks to this, a third of the students go to Oxford or Cambridge after graduation. KMLA is similar; it offers 21 AP courses and also has a unique system of course registration. KMLA students are renowned for their exceptional college admission results, with many of them securing admission to prestigious universities each year.

Leadership Education

Both schools' final goals are leadership education. In the case of Eton, they commemorate alumni who served in wars through a memorial wall. In the case of KMLA, the school's name, "Korean Minjok Leadership Academy," incorporates this value. Both schools try to raise positive leaders for society.





*In England and Wales, a public school is a type of fee-charging private school.

Beyond the Similarities

"Frankly, they don't understand the real world. They just live inside their bubble. Those kinds of schools are essentially 'nobleman factories' where the privileged children enter and emerge as part of the elite class."

Beyond the "Education of National Culture"

Beyond the education of national culture, there is a risk of extreme conservatism, which eventually deters the flexible understanding of tradition. Sometimes, stifling the tradition distorts the true meaning and purpose of the tradition.
Henry the Sixth originally founded Eton College to provide equal educational opportunities for everyone. However, since they were kind of obsessed with the tradition of the "boy school," they did not give equal educational opportunities to female students.

Beyond the "Gifted Education"

Beyond the gifted education, there is a risk of instilling a narrow perspective, leading them to believe that the education they receive is everything in the world.

One reason for this is the high tuition fee. Because of this, only rich students can realistically have a chance at public school education. The tuition fee at Eton College, for example, reaches £63,000 per year. Although Eton claims to select students based on merit, in reality, only the wealthy can afford its costs.

Rich teenagers spend their formative years in isolated dormitories, where they receive "gifted education." Books alone cannot achieve true learning; these students may excel in their studies under the guidance of excellent books and teachers, but they may also develop an extreme ignorance of the "real world" beyond their privileged bubble.

Financial Times columnist Simon Kuper, who graduated from Oxford University, once said that the elite politicians nowadays, a lot of them coming from prestigious public schools and Oxbridge, lack a sense of deep camaraderie, understanding, and community.

Beyond the "Leadership Education"

Beyond leadership education, there is a belief that they are inherently different from others. This may have instilled a sense of social responsibility, but it may also have simultaneously fostered a sense of entitlement, reinforcing the belief that their destiny was to be leaders.

At Oxford University, there is an all-male private dining club, "Bullingdon Club." This club is home to various rich British elites, including former prime ministers Boris Johnson and David Cameron from Eton. After indulging in luxurious dining, they would purposefully damage dishes and furniture, leaving the establishment in a state of disarray, and then resort to using their wallets to compensate for the damage. Such behavior likely stemmed from a sense of entitlement, as these students viewed themselves as future leaders entitled to indulgence.

KMLA Might Be Similar

Although these criticisms primarily target British public schools, our school also faces similar challenges. Thus, whenever we emulate Eton College, we adopt both its strengths and weaknesses.

At our school, the emphasis on national culture education also undermines the original purpose of the tradition. The school still argues that the skirt Hanbok is a tradition without any basis for the argument. Students provide academic arguments, including points that the pants Hanbok is the original form of the female Hanbok and also the pragmatic reasons why it is difficult to wear a long skirt uniform and walk around the campus. Basically, the goal of "tradition culture education" is ruining the original form of tradition and the first and foremost purpose of attire, safety.

We must also exercise caution to avoid developing a narrow perspective during the gifted education process. While the school puts in effort to provide a diverse educational environment, KMLAians also have to learn that there are a lot of people who don't receive such quality education.

KMLAians also run the risk of developing a sense of elitism, perceiving themselves as "born to rule," a mindset that many Eton and other public school students share. We are always educated that we are going to be future leaders, but are we KMLAians taking social responsibility as leaders?

We should reflect on whether we are turning off our room lights before we mourn loudly for climate change. We should reflect on whether we are scared of the mandatory selection rule for students in Gangwon province just because it could potentially damage our school's university admission results. We should reflect on whether we are truly striving for the betterment of humanity rather than just pursuing our own successful careers and adhering to secular values.

Then What Should We Do?

"I felt bitter when people celebrated that Squid Game ranked number one on Netflix. No one had thought to create Netflix."

As Professor Yoo Hyun-joon says, we have long valued becoming first place by following paths others have already paved. This may stem from a cultural tradition of pursuing the static ideal of the "Junzi," or perhaps from the need to achieve rapid economic growth. However, it is time to reflect on whether we fear too greatly the act of forging new, uncharted paths.

We should respect Choi Myung-jae's founding vision for KMLA, inspired by Eton College. We should actively learn from Eton College and other British public schools.

The reason for learning should not be "just because Eton College does it." Nor should we adopt their practices recklessly and inherit their problems. Before adopting Eton's policies, habits, or even ideals, there must be an explainable reason. By doing so, KMLA can forge its own uncharted path.



The Laboratory Hazards: Are They Surmountable?

Seyoung Lim

Science Labs: A Total Chaos

KMLA has many students who set their potential careers in STEM, which has become an evident trend among students worldwide. Among all the students in KMLA, 68.1% are aiming for STEM or medical academia to major in universities. Being so, the school proudly advertises advanced laboratory facilities, chemistry, and biology appearing in the school promotion video.

The reality, however, sadly contradicts the sugarcoated scenes on camera. The pictures below are the status of the chemistry lab taken in late September: baskets full of past integrated projects occupy one-third of the tables; hardly any beakers are left clean, discarded in the sinks with the reagents inside; the entire place looks as if a bomb had hit it. If one peered in, it would never be more plausible to think the place holds not hospitality, but hostility towards anyone who enters.





▲ Status of the chemistry lab taken in late September

Shockingly, this situation applies not only to the chemistry lab but to all labs in general. What happened to the science labs? Would the students have enough opportunities to pursue their academic interests in these states?

The School or the Students?

Is this crisis due to the school's ignorance or is it the students' fault? Upon hearing various opinions from students centering around science clubs, it could be concluded that it is a combination of both; the school lacks facilities, but the students also lack the skills and knowledge to conduct science experiments.

Many science clubs—SPINEL, JokBo, Hyaeumnarae, Newton, and SEM—commonly pointed out that the school was poor at supporting science experiments. "We once asked the school to stock expendable supplies—distilled water, nitrile gloves, pipette tips, and so on—but the response was that they couldn't be provided for personal use. They said all the supplies should be purchased for in-class use only," said Eugin Oh, the head of JokBo, a biology club. Taehee Kim, the vice-captain of the physics club Newton, noted, "The problem is, many facilities don't work properly. If we were to fix it ourselves, only 20% would be available for actual experiments. We don't know if the device will work for sure until we actually test them." Lastly, Soyoon Park, a member of the club SEM, informed, "The machine (SEM) has been out of order ever since the first term. It was to be fixed during the summer holidays, but there's no news until now."

While it clearly seems like the school's problem from this point of view, and, some of the reasons are undeniably based on the school, problems occurring from the students were also observable. "Many non-bio major students use the biology lab for their integrated projects," said Yoo-chan Jo, a member of Jokbo. "Many experiments are left unfinished and unorganised without the basic lab training. The club usually has to clean up all of them."



▲ before

▼ after



So it seems to become apparent: the lack of facilities, or more concisely, the poor management of the existing facilities limit the level of experiments a student can conduct. By facilities, they don't mean something grand or expensive. Moreover, the problem is aggravated by students' manners in the lab. Often, we have short knowledge of the to-do's and not-to-do's inside the lab. But again, it isn't the technical inexperience that's the main problem. It's the consideration for others, which is a calibre we should surely possess by now.

Into the Deeper Levels

Would that be all there is? Unfortunately, the issue doesn't seem like it will be resolved simply by investing more budget in the facilities. To look deeper into the fundamentals, Minjok Herald interviewed chemistry teacher Wonhyeong Jang on December 3rd. Despite starting his work at KMLA this year, he advised numerous students with their scientific experiments and managed to transform the chemistry lab into a place of some decency in his three months of stay.

Mr. Jang first claimed that the fundamental reason for the deterioration of the science labs is that KMLA is a private school with a division of natural sciences and liberal arts. Unlike science high schools where everyone can benefit from the purchase of an expensive device, there will be students who can't get the same privilege in KMLA. "The kids majoring in liberal arts are paying tuition fees for something they wouldn't ever lay their hands on," Mr. Jang explained, "which makes it hard for the school to purchase anything not for in-class use." He also added the costly facilities might not be the centre of the problem. "What's the use if no one can interpret the data it spits out?" said Mr. Jang, "It'd be better to provide unlimited access to university laboratories to the students instead."

Mr. Jang also pointed out that the student's behaviours weren't concerning in particular. "Even the juniors and seniors in Seoul National University fumble with basic equipment unless they receive graduate school lab safety training," he mentioned. "However, the students should at least be aware of things directly related to their safety." This included using heating devices and distinguishing toxic, volatile chemicals to be used inside the hood. Considering one misstep can lead to disastrous accidents, his judgments seem to be reasonable.

Minjok Herald further inquired about his opinions on restricting the usage of labs starting from the second term. While he strongly agreed that it was a dilemma, he also explained that there must be an adult legally in charge of potential accidents if students were to conduct experiments during the self-study periods and the weekends. "We thought of hiring specialised personnel, but the wage is expensive, and that applies the same to the teachers if we make them come to school outside office hours," he noted.

Mr. Jang lastly gave some of his solutions regarding the issue. Discarding the idea of establishing a chemistry club to restrict access after the possibility of a severe backlash was posed by some of the 28th wavers, he plans to recruit a student assistant group who teach basic experiment techniques to students. He expected many problems would be resolved with this system, though many would take time to be admitted. "There will be no perfect solution, but there is a definite end to the unrequited work of the current teachers," Mr. Jang stressed, "The situation will improve only when a sustainable solution arises."

What Should We Aim For?

In conclusion, the solution can be succinctly summarised: let's do the basics. It isn't some high-quality devices or graduate-level experiment skills we need to acquire. Of course, the support provided only for the STEM field could be considered unfair to liberal arts students, and it is an issue that needs mutual adjustments. However, we can't neglect the fact that 68.1% of the entire student body aims for a scientific major.

Rejecting their requests to provide essential supplies for experiments outside classes is an implicit pronouncement to limit any decent quality of scientific research–especially so for international track students, who are half mandated to conduct one for their extracurriculars or competitions.

Also, many experiments require a considerable amount of time. They do not fall into a 50-minute cycle for the students' convenience. They need full-time observation for three hours, overnight heating, seven hours of stirring and drying, or many lengthier procedures. If usage of labs during self-study periods or weekends is limited due to the absence of an adult, it is impossible to show a satisfying result in only three or five hours of project and club sessions per week, that is if you're lucky enough to be in one. A systematic solution is crucial for the consistent operation of the labs and the sake of the students.

However, we must be aware that whatever the school provides, the pleasant lab environment is fundamentally down to us. Labs are essentially public properties. They are not one-day class studios where you can leave once you're finished. To make the most out of them, it should be our priority to learn how to use them accurately and take care of them, mindful of the consequences. By doing so, we will be able to set a cornerstone for the better status of science labs, and hopefully, a replenishment in their supplies.



A Pressing Need for a Change

Hyunseo Lee

A free media is essential to a democratic society, especially when electing representative leaders. As KMLA values student autonomy, a system called the Press plays an integral role in Student Council Elections, aiming to inform busy student voters and stimulate public debate for more educated voting decisions.

However, an ideal isn't always the reality. From the first Press in the 16th Student Council Elections to the latest Press in the 38th Student Council Elections this semester, the Press has faced numerous challenges. What do the ongoing concerns tell us about journalism and student autonomy in our school? Ultimately, what can we do to overcome these challenges? In this article, Minjok Herald breaks down the current Press system and its possible future.

Is the Press Neutral Enough?

Perhaps one of the most commonly raised issues is neutrality. At a club level, two student journalism clubs (Minjok Herald and 불휘기픈나모) form one unified Press during the elections, which inevitably limits the source of information. At an individual level, as 27th Wave Soochan Jung points out, "there is a difference in reporters' perspectives on candidates' statements, opinions, and policies, as well as in how well they write their articles." In the current Press system, one Press reporter takes charge of one candidate. As a result, some candidates get reporters with a more critical tone. Since this difference may affect the student voters' final decision, the level of criticism by the Press reporters is often the primary concern of every Press Head.

Should the Press merely inform student voters with "solid facts?" Or should they also analyze each candidate's statements in a more critical manner, even if it means being subjective? Where



are the boundaries? The answer seems quite straightforward. According to the BBC, "One of the main purposes [of journalism] is to provide voters with the information they need to make informed choices." The same goes for KMLA's Press. "The role of the Press," suggested Jung, "is to provide evidence and commentary to help students make informed, desirable decisions that will best represent student autonomy." What is more difficult, of course, is to apply this standard to the actual Press articles. "Maybe that is why every Press is faced with the same dilemma and criticism from the readers, even after 11 years," he comments.

Heavy Workload Without Compensation?

Another internal problem of the Press is the heavy workload. "We write three to four articles, a comparison chart between candidates, records of Q&A sessions, and the final summary chart, and prepare the Press Q&A session in a short span of time less than two weeks," says 28th Waver Seyoung Lim, the Head of the 38th Legislative Council Press. "It is rare for us, especially the heads [of each council], to sleep before 3 AM or 4 AM during the most intense periods."

However, there is another layer to this problem. A heavy workload may be necessary for writing quality analysis articles, but the absence of compensation makes students question the necessity of their work. Press activities have long been regarded as a “voluntary duty” for journalism clubs and have not been compensated in any way. This isn’t just limited to materialistic incentives such as reward points, volunteer hours, or the getting written in school transcript, but also a higher mode of reward – self-efficacy. With little visible readership and impact of their work, members become unmotivated and find it unrewarding to participate in the Press amid their already-packed schedule.

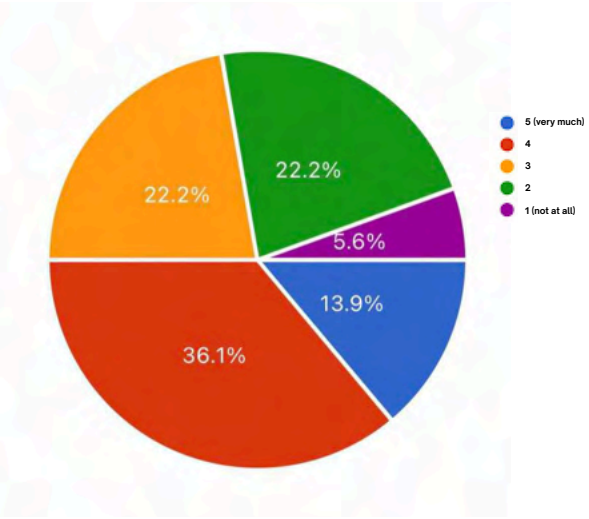
Student Journalism Without Students?

This leads us to the most persistent and fundamental concern in student autonomy: “political disengagement.” The Press cannot escape the criticism that many students are simply not interested in its activities. It’s no surprise to see students falling asleep during the mandatory Q&A Sessions, and even a Press member might agree that their articles are not the most interesting thing to read. Although voter Q&A sessions gained more attention this year, participation in Press Q&A sessions remained low. This leaves some Press writers doubting: ‘Who would take time to read the articles that I poured my time and effort into and find them actually valuable? Students are simply too busy to care.’ Is this not a red light to student autonomy?

Still, before hastily pointing at “political disengagement,” let us first reflect. Has the Press really been student-friendly and accessible in the first place? How effective are the Press articles for students to understand the elections and candidates’ stances? While recent Press articles have improved in format, they remain largely text-heavy with few visual aids where it can be beneficial. To add on, they are accessible only through Facebook, where they often get buried among other announcements. At the end of the day, maybe it is only the Press writers (and maybe the candidates) who care about what they write.

On a scale from 1 to 5, how much would you say the press uploads/activities influence your final decision on the election?

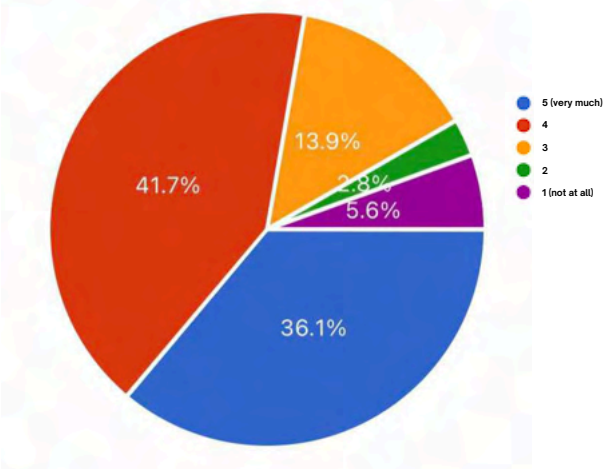
36 Responses



<Fig 1>

On a scale from 1 to 5, how much do press uploads help you understand the overall student council election?

36 Responses



<Fig 2>

Traditionally, the Press has been led by members of two already-existing journalism clubs. This can vouch for some qualifications, but it also means that the pool of students is limited from the start, leaving cold the demands from students to wish to participate in the Press. “With some basic training, I think the Press could be composed of students other than the newspaper club members who are highly interested in the Student Council Election,” says Seyoung Lim. Perhaps systematically, the Press is discharging a valuable opportunity for more students to engage in student autonomy.



What Can We Do About It?

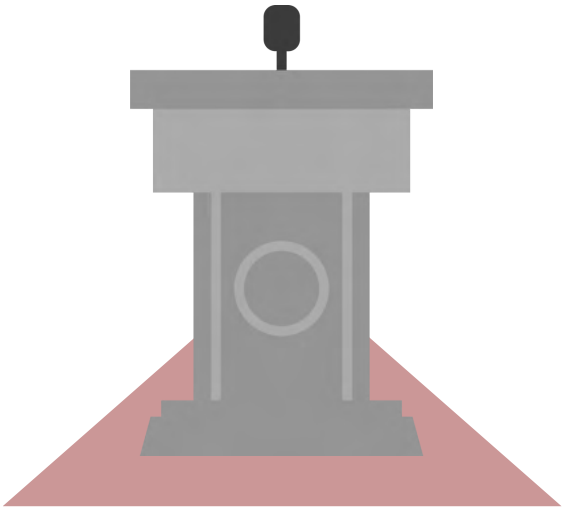
It’s clear that the Press isn’t without problems. Nevertheless, this isn’t to deny the positive aspects the Press has on Student Council Elections. In a survey that Minjok Herald conducted, many students positively evaluated the Press uploads to be helpful in understanding the elections and responded that the uploads significantly influenced their final decisions. (Fig 1,2) Interviews with the 38th Elections Committee members demonstrated an unexpected positive influence of the Press in organizing the elections and leading the two Q&A Sessions. “We rarely get third-party evaluations of candidates’ tasks or responses,” says Jiwoo Ye, a 28th Waver in the Judicial Council. “Press articles often highlighted weaknesses we missed and provided key insights for preparing questions for the second Q&A session.

Then the question we should ask here is clear: what is the best way we can amplify these virtuous functions of the Press – while not falling into the trap of mannerism – and continue to be truly democratic?

We can start by reducing the time spent on daunting, manual tasks such as summarizing candidates’ statements with the help of AI. Instead, the Press can focus more on fact-checking relevant information, writing commentaries, and visualizing the articles. It’s also important to make the articles more accessible. “We could display the more visualized articles on the televisions in Dasan and Chungmu, or print them out like posters and post them in front of the elevators so that students can invest a few minutes to read and gain interest about the election,” suggested 29th Wave Minju Kim, a Press member.

Finally, we need to incentivize and open doors for more students to participate in the Press. While giving priority to journalism club members, the Press could introduce a system of recruiting some students from outside the clubs. By going through basic qualifications and ample training, it can address the problems of neutrality and political disengagement. Compensating the effort can ensure that students are more motivated for their contribution.

Of course, these solutions are far from perfect. But when a problem is so deeply entangled, we have to start somewhere. To make democracy work in KMLA, we must first be attentive to who we choose to represent our voice. This is where journalism of, for, and by the students and the change in the Press becomes a pressing issue. And this change, dear readers, is only possible with your active readership and **participation**.



The Cactus Pricking Us: Department Equality is a Must

Jeongheon Lee



What if it wasn't only the Student Council that participated in student autonomy? What if every single student could do so directly? Is it even possible? In KMLA, it is real. The school's "One Department per Person" policy makes it mandatory that all students belong in a department. This sets KMLA apart from other schools. However, the policy is flawed in various ways with inequality. The workload difference between departments is extreme, causing problems in both personal and holistic aspects. This cactus, the "One Department per Person" policy, has many pricks hurting the school because of the dry condition; the workload imbalance. For KMLA to truly take pride in its policy, the pricks must be removed.

The desert weather of work imbalance is currently severe in the school. The numbers are quick to show that work hours per semester vary vastly among departments. To illustrate, the Department of Club Management works for half an hour a semester; departments like School Management and Science Technology work over 100 hours during the same period. This massive difference in work time and level gives the cactus its thorns–the policy its problems– both personal and holistic ones.

The problem from a personal point of view is that unequal work time causes inequality that goes beyond just departments. More time devoted to

department work means less time to spend somewhere else. For example, while a member of the Department of School Management makes posters during lunch time, other people can use that time to study for higher grades or even just get extra sleep. “It doesn’t even have to be studying or sleeping,” 29th waver Park Gyeom explained, “I usually read during lunch time, doing what I want to do. It’s a pity for departments like School Management that need to work during that time, like making posters by hand.” Student autonomy is about having students participate actively in school affairs, but if only a certain few do so and it causes differences outside of the department as well, it is clearly a problem.

Some may say that this isn’t really a problem since entering a certain department was the student’s choice. Supporting this idea, a survey showed that 59.4% of students got into their first-choice departments. However, it is too hasty to judge; take another look at the same survey, which shows nearly 40% of students knew less than half of, and only one out of ten people knew completely about the department’s work. What does this mean? This means that students applied for departments with little knowledge of them. Can this be seen as free will? No. Freshmen only had a 5-minute introduction by each department during the OT period, which caused them to rely on information from subjective sources like matching juniors. It’s unjust to hold students responsible for not being given enough information about departments’ work.

However, students applying for departments without sufficient knowledge isn’t just a problem from a personal point. It hurts the department as a whole as well. Let’s say there is a student who got placed in a high-workload department either by failing to get into others or not knowing about the amount of work. Whatever the case, the student is now forced to spend countless hours against his or her will. This becomes a holistic problem once the student chooses not to work, as it would decrease manpower and cause issues in the department.

Of course, there are solutions to members not working, such as giving penalty points to students who do not participate consistently. However, as seen in a real-life example of the Department of School Management, this isn’t as easy as it seems. “We already have much more work than other departments; giving out penalty points every time for being a little lazy is not good for the atmosphere.” Not only this, but fundamentally, forcing students to work in their departments contradicts the policy's purpose of encouraging student autonomy. They must participate willingly to keep the policy’s original spirit.

Identifying problems itself is of no use. Like the fundamental purpose of the “One Department per Person” policy is to increase student autonomy, the purpose of identifying problems is to solve them. The most straightforward way would be to solve the inequality itself. There could be several ways of doing this, including regulating minimum and maximum work time. However, measuring only time overlooks situations where the difficulty is intense despite the short duration, and the workload can be difficult to quantify.

Perhaps departments can be recreated from the root. For instance, getting rid of departments with no work and dividing departments with a lot. The Department of School Events makes a total of over 200 posters a year. Ending this culture or making them digitally can help. Restructuring departments to get rid of inequality can help solve the dry weather of department inequality.

However, differences in workload can’t perfectly be redistributed; still, some changes can be made to cut the prickles without creating a moist condition, such as allocating more time and effort to introducing departments during OT periods to prevent lazy members. In cases like these, the inequality itself is not solved, but the problems caused by the inequality can be handled. Of course, no solution is yet perfect, but having lots of ways to solve the pricks is nothing but good.

A cactus’s pricks cause pain in many ways. It is essential that such pricks be removed. But a cactus can also serve a good purpose if handled properly. After all, it carries abundant water inside. While the inequality between departments may be holding the school back, if solved properly, the “One Department Per Person” policy can provide water, and the school will be able to hold its head up again, proud of its policy.

A New Chapter of KMLA's Global Vision : EOP Renovated



Seohyeon Choi

"The goal of English Only Policy.
English is only a tool to raise Korea to the highest level by accommodating diverse civilizations and cultures in accordance with Korean tradition.
English Only Policy is merely a means, not an end in itself."

English Only Policy has been a cornerstone of KMLA's founding philosophy. Despite its significance, the policy struggled to maintain consistent enforcement over the years. Always, EOP needed a revitalized approach. As the new headmaster settled, he underscored the importance of EOP as a school nurturing global leaders. Thereafter, the school has launched new initiatives aimed at integrating English into daily life.

Teachers Preparing for EOP: Ringle

For a language to be naturally integrated into daily life, an environment fostering its use is essential, especially for KMLA students who spend much of their day in school. While KMLA's Codes of Regulations, including teachers' pledges and the Constitution, mandate English Only Policy for all classes except Korean and Korean History, most teachers struggle to teach or even communicate in English. With ambitions to improve, and to begin preparations for the headmaster's plan to adopt the International Baccalaureate program, the school has partnered with "Ringle," an online 1:1 English tutoring service, to improve English usage in everyday and academic settings.

Mr. Yang Donghyuk, one of the teachers who uses Ringle, gave positive reviews. Being in the social position of a "teacher", it was harder for him to learn or use English due to pressure. However, since Ringle matches a tutor who doesn't know the user, Mr. Yang is able to speak freely in English without any hesitation or shame. He added that having time to talk fully in English for 40 minutes per week is helpful in itself.

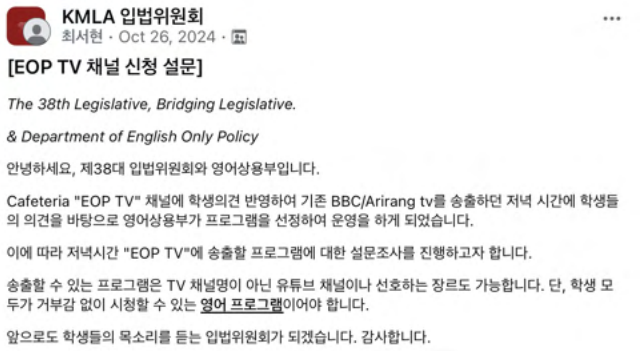
Students: EOPeople

It isn't only teachers; students also seek ways to induce spontaneous and active English use. The head and vice head of the EOP department, Seoeun Yang and Sangmin Lee, gathered the most EOP-engaged students from juniors and founded EOPeople.

This group holds one big premise: To only use English among the members. For a better understanding, Minjok Herald interviewed Sangmin Lee, one of the founders.

"EOPeople was based on the thought that EOP had to start bottom up." About its expected effect, he stated, "I know that given the limited size of the group, there can't be any major effects, but I hope that the group can grow into a nice community that exists to show the others in the school 'hey, it's not wrong to speak English in your daily life!'"

Yet, Lee added that the key factor would be the "voluntary" participation of the students, which was the point of gathering enthusiastic friends who would like the idea of EOPeople.





NEOP: The EOP TV & EOP Lunch Table (a.k.a. ELT)

Ever since the April First incident*, the school has encountered problems with penalizing and forcing students to use English. The school founded the EOP Committee which included the headmaster, the head teacher of Student Affairs, and the EOP Department head and vice head. Later, the Student Legislative Council entered. There, the opinion evolved that rather than mandating, incentivizing students to induce voluntary participation would be a better option.

For this reason, the newest idea to materialize is the EOP TV and EOP Lunch Table policy. These student-friendly systems intend to expose students to English and encourage its use by providing incentives.

For EOP TV, every mealtime, a total of eleven televisions in the cafeteria broadcast English programs in close proximity to each table. However, not everything went as expected. The volume was too loud and some channels were inappropriate; broadcasting ASMR and speaking in Korean only with English captions. Soon after, the EOP Committee, which attentively listened to the students' opinions, convened a conference that allowed student-requested programs and lowered the volume of every TV in the cafeteria.

In addition, EOP Lunch Tables (ELTs) are now designated in the center of the cafeteria for 36 students who have applied to participate in English-language lunch sessions three times a week. With the supervision of the EOP Department, participants converse in English while enjoying their lunch. Students who consistently participate throughout the week are rewarded with a point for their active engagement.

These new policies are currently well settled with positive responses from students and teachers.

Concerns for the 30th Wave

This year, the school's admission process has gone through a notable change. Schools are not allowed to conduct an English interview, and the interview must be finished within 15 minutes. Compared to previous years, in which students took five 20-minute interviews in various fields, including English, it has indeed become uncertain if KMLA can admit the fittest students.

Thus, there is a high probability that KMLA's next wave will be comparably inconsistent, and if so, it is important to help them adapt to EOP. It's also a given that an English-using environment must be formed before the 30th wave enters the school for EOP to remain a core feature of KMLA's identity.

The recent revival of EOP through various efforts and creative initiatives has started to rehabilitate English usage in school. Through Ringle, teachers started to participate in EOP in earnest, and through ELT and EOP TVs, students are now naturally exposed to English in their daily lives. However, for the policy to truly succeed, it requires not only structural support but also the enthusiasm and voluntary engagement of the students. A group like EOPeople should rather be the whole school community. Thus the next challenge is to foster an atmosphere, with the 30th wave, where using English becomes a natural and fun part of daily life. Perhaps, these policies will help English usage in KMLA to thrive.

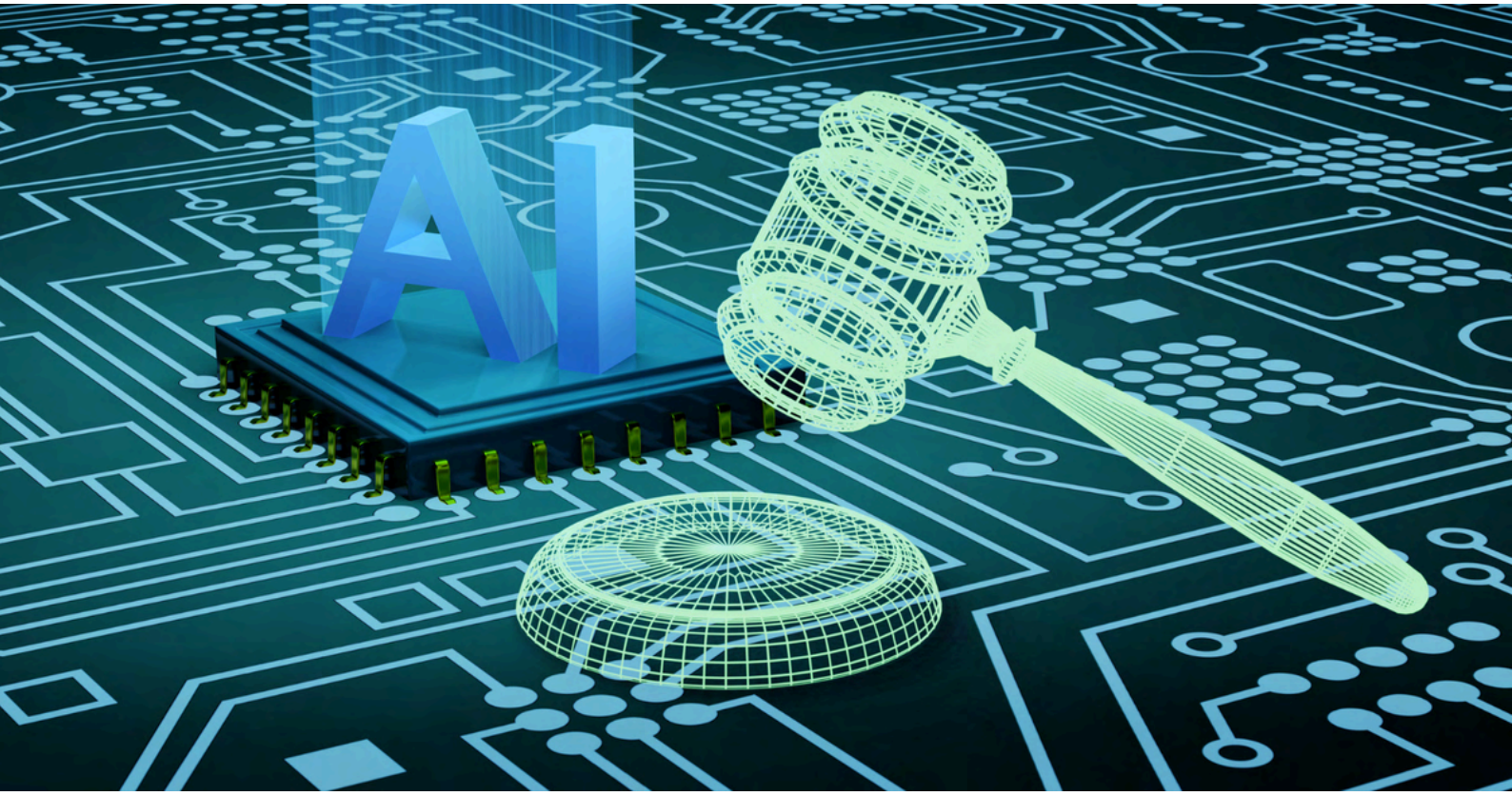
Innovation at a Cost: The Stark Reality in the Age of AI

Jeongmin Lee



Generative AI has been widely popularized nowadays, becoming loved even by our teachers as well as students. Artificial intelligence is truly one of the most defining developments of this era. From school assignments to funny reels, our lives today are arguably somewhat codependent on AI. However, with this new change comes several unforeseen ethical issues. These problems are not only philosophical questions but are directly related to our safety and rights to privacy. People have raised questions on a number of aspects, such as privacy and misuse. The rapid development and implementation of generative AI have sparked numerous debates, and a serious conversation on its ethical implications is long overdue.

The most pressing problem with AI is the criminal use of AI-generated media. This issue puts every single Internet user at risk. At the current point of development, it is possible to generate realistic media with the click of a button. This ability is frequently abused for illegal or otherwise harmful activities, such as fake news or fraud. Unfortunately, this has opened opportunities for deception rather than the advancement of human society. An example is that the use of AI in sexual crime has skyrocketed. This has been especially prominent recently in Korea. In July 2023, a Korean man was charged with sex offense for creating and owning hundreds of AI child pornography. Another more recent incident is one that shook teenagers all over the nation; a number of online group chats, consisting of mostly teenagers, have been reported for generating pornographic material using the faces of their schoolmates. Fortunately, no students at KMLA were victims of this issue, but this incident still reminds us that these problems are not far-fetched from our lives. We also have to consider concerns about data ownership. Most generative AI is trained through data scraping, which means that any and all existing data on the Internet could be fed into AI training mechanisms. For this kind of free data, the original owners' explicit consent is not necessarily required, and developers prefer to keep it this way. Moreover, for creative communities such as artists, this means that their work is being nonconsensually imitated by computers to create an infinitely faster

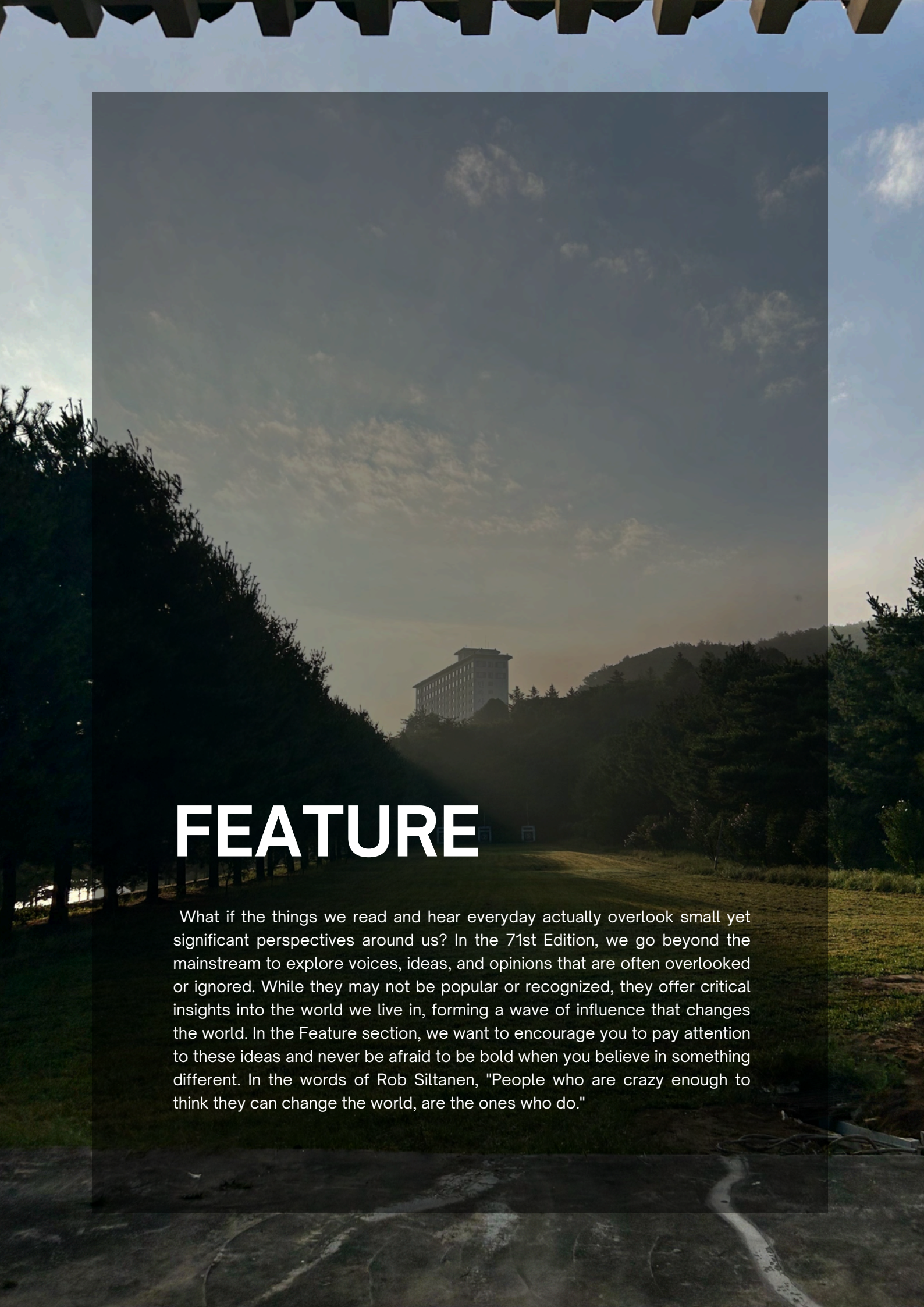


alternative devoid of human emotion. Some people have been raising concerns about the fact that Meta recently started using user content to train Meta AI, meaning that our Instagram and Facebook posts are being used to train AI.

Perhaps the most common way we as students use AI is in assignments. There is a fine line between using AI to learn more effectively and being cognitively reliant on AI. Little by little, we are forgetting how to write essays, think up ideas, or do research without the help of ChatGPT. Not only does this undermine academic integrity, but it also hinders the learning process. Relying on AI leads to the atrophy of problem-solving skills and independent critical thinking. Thus, by constantly using AI in assignments, we are losing our ability to critically analyze information and develop independent ideas.

The damage of this loss is magnified by another concerning problem of misinformation. Reliance on AI also leads to misinformation. ChatGPT is a language model, not a search engine, and therefore using it as such can be risky. AI chatbots like ChatGPT are excellent at persuasively presenting false narratives. They also give wrong or outdated information when asked to solve questions or do research. For example, according to a recent study done at Purdue University, 52% of responses by ChatGPT on computer programming were incorrect. Another report by the New York Times informs that OpenAI chatbots produced around 3% of misinformation and others up to 27%, although the statistics vary by the task. In a time when critical thinking and research skills are most important, we are losing these abilities.

AI is a double-edged sword. While it can be used to revolutionize work and research, it can just as well be used to damage what we once took for granted. The baseline for safety and authenticity on the Internet is plummeting to the ground. Although legal regulation is outside of our reach, we still need to be more cautious about how we use AI. Instead of letting it blur the lines in our perception, we can learn how to fact-check what we see by paying attention to small details and double-checking when we come across sketchy information. AI is the future, but it's up to us to leave room for human safety and authenticity.



FEATURE

What if the things we read and hear everyday actually overlook small yet significant perspectives around us? In the 71st Edition, we go beyond the mainstream to explore voices, ideas, and opinions that are often overlooked or ignored. While they may not be popular or recognized, they offer critical insights into the world we live in, forming a wave of influence that changes the world. In the Feature section, we want to encourage you to pay attention to these ideas and never be afraid to be bold when you believe in something different. In the words of Rob Siltanen, "People who are crazy enough to think they can change the world, are the ones who do."

Paths Less Traveled : Dare to Dream Your Dream

Seoeun Bae

What do you think you'll be doing 20 years from now? If you came up with an answer right away but hesitated to say it out loud, think about why you did. Is it possible that you're afraid your dream might be looked down on for not following the mainstream? The truth is, this fear is more common than you might think. Many of us worry that choosing a path that isn't widely accepted or understood could lead to certain judgments. Curious about their experiences on this matter, Minjok Herald spoke to several KMLA alumni who experienced similar struggles.



We interviewed Juwon Song, a 21st waver who is currently a senior at Seoul National University studying landscape architecture. Juwon had initially dreamed of becoming a research engineer. She pursued that dream early on during her time at KMLA, taking research-focused classes. However, she realized that she wasn't that interested in the field. Instead, she decided to change course and aim to become a doctor, following what seemed like a conventional and respected career path. Juwon even took the KSAT three times, hoping to get a score high enough to go to a medical school.

But during her third year of preparing for the exam, she began to feel like she had lost her purpose. It was then that she made the bold decision to leave behind the expectations of others and choose a career that she would truly enjoy. She loves spending time outdoors and has a good taste in art in general. After a few years of choosing to study landscape architecture, she found out that being in the mainstream is not everything and now loves what she does.

Do you think what you did in KMLA influenced your life afterward?

Yes, definitely. Even apart from all of the studying I did in KMLA, the three years I spent in the school were a kind of a turning point for me. Looking back, I don't think I knew myself before high school. During KMLA, I had the chance to think about life itself and met a lot of great people. The people I met during high school are one of the most important and precious relationships for me even now. I learned how to sort out life during high school.

What advice do you want to give to KMLAians still in school?

The most important thing is knowing yourself. Talk with your roommates, and write about your feelings. What helped me the most was writing a diary. These help clear your mind a lot. Also, don't try to look for your future too far away. If you want to do something you enjoy, what you're doing in your daily routine can be your career.

Have you ever been anxious or regretful that you chose "something different"?

I feel like I always have some kind your worry for my future. However, this never came from choosing a unique career; rather, I always worry about whether my choices are the right choices for me. You can't force yourself to not be anxious, as everyone worries about something in their own way.

We also spoke with Dongjun Gwak, a 19th waver who is preparing to debut as a professional artist. Originally, he focused on physics and had planned on going to an engineering school. However, when the time came to apply for university, Dongjun decided to take a completely different route and applied to design school instead. He now works as an artist, specializing in interactive media art. Looking back, he says, “At the time, I applied to a design school because I could, but now I think it was the right choice.”

Do you think what you did in KMLA influenced your life afterward?

You might not believe this, but what I learned in high school is very helpful to me even as an artist. For example, I learned Java during the first year of high school and this is one of my strengths as a media artist.

Also working in the ‘Meme Factory’ club, helped me find my interest in design. I did my work during high school and these experiences became a huge asset for me.

What advice do you want to give to KMLAians still in school?

You don’t have to rush it. I feel like you end up finding what you like and choosing your career. Also, I think KMLA is one of the best schools for finding what you enjoy. Try to take many classes that look fun to you and don’t be afraid of failing. I believe in learning along the way.

Have you ever been anxious or regretful that you chose “something different”?

You can’t deny being anxious about the future, especially pursuing a career as an artist. A lot of my friends are now working or getting phDs etc. However, I don’t regret my choices. It’s more like I try not to. If you start regretting it really doesn’t end. I think it is best just not to start.



Thinking about the future is always scary because you can never be sure of anything. However, it is because you can’t be sure of anything that you should pursue what you truly want. After all, the unknown holds endless possibilities, and taking risks is the only way to discover what’s waiting for you. And you’re not alone! Along with the two alumni we interviewed, many more KMLAians chose the path they wanted without a doubt. Even if they are in different stages in life pursuing different things, they have one thing in common. They don’t regret choosing the unconventional path. This leaves you, the one on the forked road, with really only one choice. Pursue what you want, even if it defies convention, and create a life that’s authentically yours.

Opening Doors to All : Ensuring Accessibility at KMLA

Seoeun Yang

Ready, set, go.

Your quest: reach the top floor of the building within 10 minutes. The twist? Your feet cannot touch the ground. You have chosen your mode of transportation as a wheeled vehicle. The clock is ticking. Go!

As you roll closer to the entrance, your first obstacle comes into view: stairs.



The unforgiving barrier makes it clear that your wheeled vehicle is not welcome here. The only way forward is to abandon it.

As a consequence of abandoning your vehicle, you must continue your journey on stilts. Using one hand to hold the sticks and one hand to hold the door open, the seemingly easy task proves to be another challenge, with two consecutive doors blocking your way. Between grunts, you push through.

As soon as you enter the building, another set of stairs awaits you. You look around the lobby for any sign of an elevator, anything to make the journey to the top easier. Your desperate search proves to be useless. There are no elevators. Time is running out, and you must get to the top. Climbing the stairs without having your feet touching the ground seems to be a near-impossible task.

The entrance to the third floor is easy to spot. The only problem is, it's shrouded by a mass of NPCs frantically moving around, creating noise, commotion, and most importantly, blocking your way. You push through the wave of people down the narrow hallway.

Opening the blue door reveals another set of stairs. You hurry towards your destination. You check the time. 15 minutes have passed. The four-letter word FAIL pops up on your screen.

What if this wasn't just a game? What if the building were Dasan, you, a student attending KMLA, and the NPCs, fellow students? The 10 minutes is the amount of time given for students to move from one class to another. 15 minutes to reach the classroom means you've already missed the start of class.

Currently, in Dasan and Chungmoo, the only way to get to the second and third floors is by going up the stairs. There are no elevators. This makes it impossible for wheelchair users to access the classrooms on the upper floors. The Minjok Building and the English Building present additional accessibility challenges, such as thresholds at their entrances and raised classroom floors, further limiting mobility for those using wheeled devices. KMLA lacks accessibility, which limits the diversity of students who can attend. KMLA prides itself in shaping global leaders, but its current infrastructure excludes students with disabilities. Can we really call ourselves future global leaders when in reality, we are not even making an effort to be inclusive?

So what do we need? Through an interview with Mr. Alexander Ganse, a history teacher at KMLA, we came up with a two-pronged solution: ramps and elevators.

Ramps are a relatively affordable yet effective measure that can improve accessibility. The ramps need to be installed in the English building as well as the Minjok Building. The entrances of these buildings lack accessibility. The only way to enter the English building is through the stairs. The Minjok Building has thresholds at its doors, making it nearly impossible for wheeled vehicles to enter. In the Minjok Building, the classrooms are located about a foot off the ground. Ramps installed at the entrances as well as in front of the teachers' doors in the Minjok building would make these areas accessible to all.

Elevators are necessary in buildings with multiple floors, like Dasan and Chungmu. The elevators do not have to be inside the buildings. Instead, they can be placed next to the buildings, which will allow students to get from one floor to another without the inside of the buildings having to go under construction, minimizing disruption.



Through an interview with headmaster Park Hashik, we were able to get an insight into how the school views this issue:

Were there any special measures taken to improve accessibility for people with disabilities in the school buildings and facilities?

At the time, it was impossible to access Chungmu and Dasan with a wheelchair. Therefore, we have since improved accessibility by adding ramps to the entrances of both Dasan and Chungmu, as well as to the pathway leading to the sports field.

What future plans does the school have to improve accessibility for people with disabilities?

We plan to gradually improve the facilities, starting with ensuring that restrooms inside the school buildings are fully accessible for people with disabilities.

There have been suggestions about installing elevators in Dasan and Chungmu. Are there any plans related to this installation?

There are no plans to install elevators as of now, but I believe it could be considered in the future.

What is your opinion on improving accessibility?

The entrance system already allows students with disabilities to apply for admission. In the future, we aim to improve our school so that students with disabilities can attend without experiencing inconveniences. Education for both disabled and non-disabled students together is called inclusive education. Research shows that inclusive education helps both disabled and non-disabled students with their overall growth and improvement of social skills. I believe that our school should adopt such an inclusive education system in the future.

While the school has taken some measures to improve accessibility, much more needs to be done. It's clear that we need to take further steps, such as installing elevators and addressing barriers in key buildings, to foster an environment that is open to all.

Some may question the need for these changes when the school currently does not have any disabled students attending. However, the lack of students with disabilities stems from the lack of accessible infrastructure, which discourages them from applying in the first place. We should be making more of an effort to create an environment that encourages everyone to apply. By making adjustments towards accessibility, KMLA can foster a truly inclusive environment– one that values equal opportunity and diversity.

It is now time for KMLA to truly open its doors to all.

Where Are You From?

Eva Yeda Moon

If anyone goes around asking the question, “Where are you from?” in our country, the overwhelming response would likely be, “South Korea.” This is because the vast majority of the country’s citizens are ethnically South Korean, according to the World Fact Book. The same holds true within the walls of KMLA, where nearly all students share the same ethnic background. Among hundreds of students, only a small handful come from different ethnicities. This raises an important question:

Does South Korea, and by extension KMLA, need more ethnic diversity?



In such a society where ethnic diversity is limited, it’s natural to wonder why diversity is necessary at all. Nevertheless, diversity fosters a more inclusive environment by encouraging mutual respect and understanding among people from different backgrounds. It also brings various perspectives that can drive innovation and challenge traditional ways of thinking. Furthermore, exposure to diverse cultures and ideas prepares individuals to engage with a globalized world, where collaboration across cultural boundaries is increasingly vital. These benefits are not abstract; they apply directly to South Korea, its educational system, and institutions like KMLA, where students are being shaped to become future leaders in an interconnected world.

While South Korea’s multicultural population has been growing due to immigration, particularly from neighboring countries, the question remains: do Koreans fully embrace this shift toward diversity? South Korea is on the statistical verge of becoming a multicultural society, but socially and culturally, many Koreans still hold onto a more traditional sense of national identity. This is reinforced by the country's adherence to “jus sanguinis”—the principle that citizenship is based on descent rather than birthplace. Some argue that to truly become a multicultural society, South Korea must consider adopting “jus soli,” granting citizenship based on birth within the country. This shift could help alter perceptions and pave the way for a more inclusive society.

KMLA is a school known for promoting traditional Korean values—arguably more than the nation itself. This focus on preserving tradition raises the question of whether the school can be a home for students from different cultural and historical backgrounds. Should KMLA promote ethnic diversity as part of its mission? Or is it destined to remain an institution primarily for Koreans? The lack of diversity at KMLA is not merely a reflection of South Korean society but a missed opportunity to expose students to different perspectives and experiences. As a school that aims to produce future global leaders, KMLA could benefit greatly from embracing a more ethnically diverse student body.



In an interview with headmaster Park Hashik, he noted the inevitability of accepting the global flow of racial diversity. Further, he remarked that KMLA is, in fact, already taking the intermediate step toward cultural variety via the newly enforced admissions process for the minority–including students from multicultural families. Since KMLA has EOP as part of the global leadership notion, the school is nothing but ready to accept people of diversity. Despite such foundational works, headmaster Park established that the essential reason for the lack of diversity within Korean schools is the system that hinders the natural influx of foreigners into Korea. He believes there is a need for change in this, in order for the international status of KMLA–and other Korean schools–to rise. He anticipates KMLA, as a school that promotes Korean traditions, has merit for students around the globe. Ultimately, KMLA aims for 20% of the school's students to be ethnically divergent.



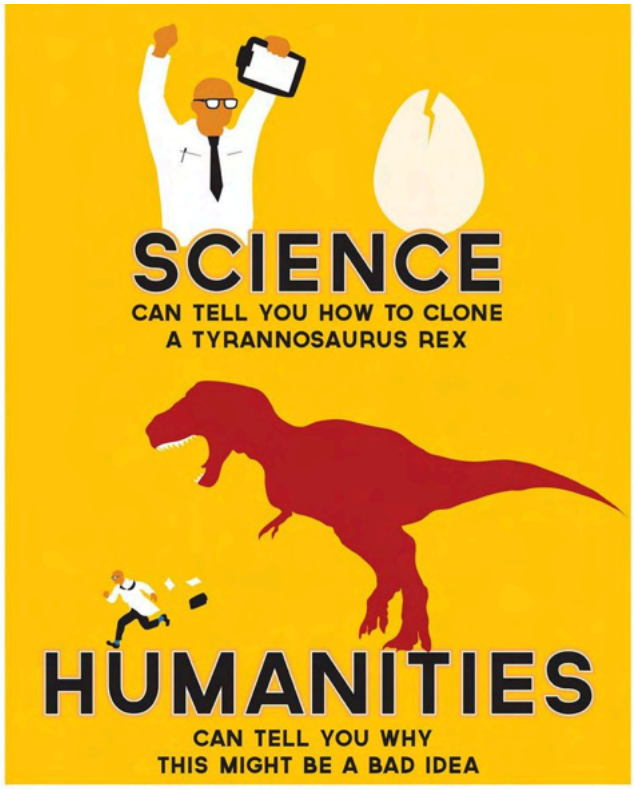
Although the proportion of ethnically diverse individuals in South Korea is increasing, it is still difficult to see this reflected in everyday life, especially in places like KMLA. The school continues to promote a form of ethnonationalism by largely excluding students from different ethnic backgrounds. A potential solution could be found by looking at other prestigious schools around the world. Many institutions have successfully balanced tradition with an embrace of diversity, creating spaces where students from all backgrounds can thrive. KMLA could learn from these examples, paving the way for a more inclusive future while maintaining its strong cultural identity.

STEM vs Humanities: Pursuing Harmony in a World of Progress

Minju Kim

What do smartphones, self-driving cars, and the ever-mysterious ChatGPT have in common? They all owe their existence to the rise of STEM fields. But here's a question: where would we be without the humanities to ask, "Should we?" instead of just "Can we?" In a school like KMLA, where over two-thirds of students plan to pursue STEM careers, it's easy to assume the humanities might be taking a backseat.

Is this shift just a natural trend, or is there more beneath the surface?

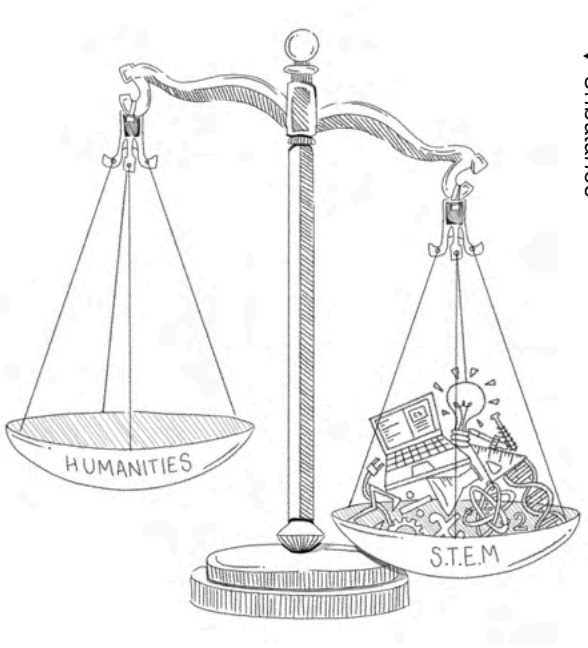


▲ Science VS Humanities

To answer this, we need to consider South Korea's societal structure, shaped by its economy, culture, and education. With a focus on technological advancements rather than natural resources, the demand for STEM fields has grown significantly. This shift in the economy has made STEM careers increasingly desirable, as they are associated with stability and high income. Consequently, societal preferences naturally favor these careers, creating a bias that influences students' decisions. Many feel pressured to pursue STEM fields, seeing them as the most secure path to success, which can overshadow other disciplines and limit interest in non-STEM careers. This societal bias not only affects career choices but also shapes the education system, often prioritizing STEM subjects over others, leading to an imbalance in the development of a well-rounded workforce.

Despite these trends, many KMLA students resist being swayed by this social atmosphere. The survey and interviews that Minjok Herald conducted about students' views on different career paths highlighted that most students (76.9%) value STEM and humanities equally and choose their careers based on their own talents and passions. While 84.6% acknowledged experiencing a STEM-preferred atmosphere, only 25% said it significantly affected their career choices. Additionally, three interviewee students responded that they all had experienced their teachers, family members, and friends preferring STEM and students in humanities being self-deprecating. This reflects the notion that KMLA students prioritize passion over societal expectations, although they are somewhat affected by it. This is likely due to the school's strong emphasis on academic exploration and personal growth.

In interviews, three students pursuing different fields shared their thoughts. Chaewon Lee, a STEM student, remarked, “Without the foundation and policies provided by humanities, technology risks being misused.” This highlights real-world concerns such as ethical dilemmas in AI and the development of harmful technologies. For example, the vast development of AI technology has made our lives much more abundant and efficient. However, it is the role of the humanities to keep people using this revolutionary technology ethically, so STEM fields can continue the developments. Youngin Gil, aiming for the medical field, emphasized, “Success isn’t just about financial gain—it’s about personal fulfillment.” She remarks on the important role of a career when it comes to an individual’s life, and how it is just more than a method of earning income. A humanities student added, “Choosing a career based on passion ensures greater satisfaction in the long run.” Like how military weapons cannot be used without social restriction and laws, and infrastructure technologies would not come to reality without the government’s permission and knowing the demand for it, STEM without humanities is often powerless or dangerous. These perspectives of KMLA students reinforce the idea that STEM and humanities must complement each other to build a balanced society. Plus, it implies the need for leaders who are knowledgeable both in STEM and humanities.



◀ Unbalance

In conclusion, the preference for STEM fields, while understandable given societal needs, should not overshadow the importance of humanities. At KMLA, students already somewhat embody this balance, valuing all fields and fostering convergent thinking. By continuing to respect diverse passions and guiding students to make choices based on their interests, we can aspire to be a society that appreciates the significance of both STEM and humanities.



Yes, There Are Black Swans —In Our Lives

Sangmin Lee

All swans were white until 1697. This European "fact" was shattered when Willem de Vlamingh spotted the very first black swan in Australia – disproving the "fact" backed by the millions of empirical evidence that had accumulated over the past. This interesting anecdote does not concern itself with the color of birds; it illustrates just how limited and fragile our knowledge and predictions are.

Nassim Nicholas Taleb, author of "The Black Swan," developed a concept inspired by this event. According to his definition,

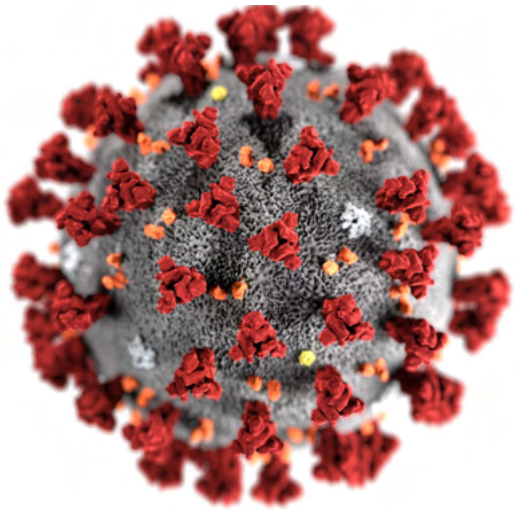
> 'Black Swan events are high-impact, unpredictable occurrences that gain an explanation after they have already happened.'

They are outliers, operating outside regular expectations or prediction models – and they also have high impacts, often leading to significant changes in the world. Most peculiarly, they seem to gain post hoc explanations claiming that the events were predictable when in fact, no one could have known.



▼ Dormitory of KMLA

In his book, Taleb claims that just about any historical event of significance – from the World Wars to the rise of the Internet – follows Black Swan dynamics. In this article, we explore Black Swan events, but in the context of our school, KMLA.



▲ COVID-19

First let's consider COVID-19, a recent example of a Black Swan event that hit globally as well as our school. Little explanation needs to be made for its unpredictability and impact: no one saw a worldwide pandemic coming that would lead to millions of deaths and global economic recessions. Schools worldwide, including KMLA, had to adjust to the new "online classes." Also, as Black Swan events do, the emergence of this virus gained a convenient justification afterward, as many experts claimed that COVID-19 should have been anticipated based on the occurrence of past pandemics.

Part of the reason we are blind to Black Swan events is our tendency to gather past observations as evidence for the future. The European belief that all swans were white was based on millions of empirical evidence, and each new time they were right; until they weren't. Unknown variables that operate beneath our sights and prediction models – they are the driving force behind Black Swan events.

But, we ask, aren't Black Swan events too rare to care about? While certainly rare, Taleb points out that they are often *the* very events that change the world. We "tend to see pennies instead of the dollars," he claims, summarizing human history as something that does not crawl but jumps. Turning our eyes to our school, we observe a similar phenomenon; Black Swan events in KMLA.

'April 1st, English Only Policy.'

It's safe to say that most students as well as teachers were unaware of the sudden changes in the policy. Student-to-student prosecution was implemented with very little notice, and it became a fervid topic that led to the changes being overturned, while communication and debate regarding EOP increased significantly. This notes an instance of Black Swan dynamics in play – for years, EOP had been crawling with minor changes that saw little effect, and with one unpredictable event, it has jumped to a topic of avid discussion.

Rare as Black Swan events seem, their traces are all around us; certainly, the impacts of the unpredictable far outlast the predictable. This realization begs the next question: How do we predict them, or, as that is impossible, at least prepare for them? Taleb mentions solutions for general events, such as diversifying the investment of resources and avoiding overconfidence in traditional predictive models. However, some of his suggestions and concepts are noteworthy in our school environment.

'Robustness'.

He suggests that systems should be robust; that is, structures should be able to withstand unexpected shocks rather than only optimizing for normal conditions. This points to one important tool: communication. Communication within any environment guarantees active problem-solving and productive progress, and it is no different in KMLA. The Student Council has a crucial role to play here, and we can assume that the EOP changes could have been less damaging had there been sufficient communication beforehand.

'Antifragility'.

The concept refers to systems that benefit from stress and volatility instead of being damaged; small failures should be tolerated and the focus should be on moving forward instead of obsessing over past failures. EOP stands as another example here, but this time a positive one; the Student Council was quick to implement changes and gather feedback, and now in the second semester the policy is moving toward progressive change. The student body, while initially harshly critical of the April 1st implementation, was keen on participating in discussions and suggesting alternative solutions. Perhaps we can already see some aspects of Antifragility in our school.

Taleb's concept of Black Swan events has faced criticism for its extreme divergence from the mainstream. Critics argue that he overemphasizes the risks and oversimplifies real-world events, and some point out that he fails to provide concrete, implementable solutions. Nonetheless, it is clear that we can learn something from this fresh concept; that we have to look beyond the normal and prepare for the unseen, as they are the moving forces of this world. KMLA has had its share of Black Swan events, and we see that the school is continually improving its ways. Perhaps we can even use this lens in our personal lives - what could be something that you don't expect that completely changes your life?

Source: Taleb, Nassim Nicholas. *The Black Swan: The Impact of the Highly Improbable*. 2nd ed., Random House, 2010.

Interview with 21st Waver Joung Taewoong

: Life in the Netherlands, Life in the World of Passion

Sangmin Lee

If you're an international student at KMLA, chances are you're looking to attend university in the United States or the United Kingdom. Such was the case for 21st Waver Joung Taewoong, who now attends Leiden University in the Netherlands. His unique path – being the only ever KMLA alumni to major in archaeology – is special to say the least, and charts far off the mainstream grid. Minjok Herald had the invaluable opportunity to interview him, to gain insights, to see what adventures lie in the world we are so foreign to.

How was your school life at KMLA? What experiences are most memorable?

It is difficult to define what my school life was like. Academically, I wasn't far away from average, though I remember there being a big deviation between subjects. I wasn't the most diligent in terms of lifestyle, but I also wasn't a troublemaker. If there is one thing I can be sure of, it's that I grew as a person during the 3 years at KMLA, which I'm sure many students will agree with. And even after all this time I still have fond memories of LID, so I guess this could be a nice little shoutout to the club.

What is it like attending university in the Netherlands? What are some differences to life in Korea?

I find that the universities in the Netherlands have a different role than those in South Korea. We might study less here, but that's because the focus is on preparing you as an independent member of society and providing experience, especially during your Bachelor's degree. I was concerned at first too, about not studying as much, but it was a helpful period for me to adjust to the new environment in retrospect.

What career path did you choose, and why?

While studying archaeology might be a unique career path, it didn't start off with a grand or noble cause. When I was in KMLA, I wanted to major in history, but I found that there were limits to how many new things I could discover. So, looking for a more empirical approach, I figured I'd try archaeology for a year and turn back if it wasn't for me. Leiden University had an English curriculum on archaeology so I applied, and it turns out it was the perfect choice for me, which is why I'm still studying it now.

We know you've walked a different path than most. What choices or activities made your life as unique as it is now?

I don't believe my life is especially unique compared to some others in KMLA; for one, I hadn't studied abroad when I was young, and I wasn't too good at English either. If there is one thing, I might say it is my tendency



to choose boldly according to my beliefs that might seem, at times, reckless. I believe any normal person can make these choices if they have the right convictions. The thing is, these paths usually have no precedent, so it's necessary to grasp your chance before you spend too much time worrying and lose the opportunity.

Do you ever regret choosing to lead a "different" life?

There was a period when I felt it was a shame that I hadn't applied during the regular season after getting accepted into Leiden. Some of my other friends were studying in famous universities in the US or UK, and at times I did feel lesser in comparison. But as more time passes here in the Netherlands, I can only think that I made the right choices because I'm so happy and content here. Now, there's nothing to regret.

Do you have anything to say to KMLA students or students who are looking to pursue a unique career?

KMLA might seem like a school that encourages your own bold path. But we know there are subtle atmospheres between each other, having to do what you are expected to do, by friends or parents or teachers. It was the same for me, and often I had doubts whether I was going the right way. But I want you to remember that it's you who has to go to university and live the rest of your life. You have a future ahead of you, and making a few mistakes won't screw your life up. So, you should really believe in the path you are passionate about, and not give up.



Beyond the Mainstream: A Final Word

As we close the pages of this edition, we leave you with a simple thought: the mainstream may shape the world, but it does not define it.

Life in KMLA sometimes feels like a narrow path, shaped by all kinds of expectations—grades, college applications, and a set, ordinary future. We often hear that we should follow the patterns and trust what has worked before. Any valuable success we achieve is measured in terms of numbers, titles, and probabilities. But beyond the mainstream, there is a world shaped by those who dared to step off the path, who sought meaning in passion, not just in predictability.

The ideas we've shared in this edition—about alumni pursuing unconventional careers, shedding light on overlooked voices, and exploring extraordinary ideas—remind us that the world is vast, unpredictable, and rich with possibilities. The future is not just for those who follow the charts but also for those who create new ones. The artist, the entrepreneur, the scientist who takes a risk, the writer who tells an untold story—all of them shape what comes next.

So as you step forward, remember this: the mainstream is not the only way forward. The world thrives when individuals think differently, ask the hard questions, and bring passion to what they do. It needs you—not just as another predictable outcome, but as a beacon of change.

Thank you for exploring Beyond the Mainstream with us. The next step is yours.

“Do not go where the path may lead;
go instead where there is no path.”

—Ralph Waldo Emerson

